

Esme Lamb

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A constitution bardette with high charisma and dips into intelligence and wisdom.

UX focused platform engineer with strong fundamentals and an eye for over-engineering. Results oriented, highly cross-functional, and able to take the lead on serious conversations.

A confident public speaker and mentor who is passionate about sharing her knowledge in an approachable way, and uplifting her fellow engineers.

Employment History

Staff Software Engineer, 2024 (Feb) - 2025 (Nov), Slack Technologies

Maintainer of primary web-serving and cache infrastructure

- A Vitess/GRPC reverse proxy to handle connection pooling from the webapp to the datastores. A critical connector of two of the largest tier 0 services at Slack.
- Productionization and maintenance of in-house database proxy prototype.
- Evaluation of off-the-shelf database proxy tooling compared to in-house prototype.

Other Responsibilities

- SME for cache infrastructure and webapp deployment machinery.
- Primary on-call for team owned tier 0 services.
- On-call Major Incident Commander for Sev-0, Sev-1, and Sev-2 company wide incidents.

Senior Software Engineer, 2021 (Feb) - 2024 (Feb), Slack Technologies

Maintainer of primary web-serving and cache infrastructure

- Cache system AZ affinity migration.
- Cache loadtesting, right-sizing, performance tuning, and cost reduction.
- Cache deploy infra and operating system upgrades.
- First evaluation of a Tier 0 service on arm64.
- Led cross functional discussions to clarify ownership of deployment machinery.
- SME for cache and deployments and on-call duties as mentioned.

Owner of container orchestration platform

- Tech lead on GovSlack compute platform buildout. Migrated container platform to a new set of datacenters modified for US government compliance. Unblocked service owners to meet a company-wide public release date.
- Platform web API. Exposed endpoints for developers to build and deploy, run integration tests, and interact with running deployments.
- Platform visibility tooling. A unified, self-serve, consolidated view of platform components. It's still heavily in use today.
- SME for container platform and on-call duties as mentioned.

Software Engineer, 2018 (Dec) - 2021 (Feb), Slack Technologies

Owner of VM and container platforms, base OS images, and network

- Container debug web tooling. Built confidence for VM users to containerize their services, preserving operational workflows with added safety, security, and auditability. Early platform adopters shifted from sceptics to promoters. The system is still in use today.
- VM deployment safety tooling. A series of change related incidents presented a risk to infra development. To strike a balance between safety, cadence, and engineering investment, I created a metrics-driven fail-safe mechanism.

- Overhaul of base VM images. As owners of the base OS for ~15-30k EC2 instances, facing an impending EOL and deep code complexities, I collaborated on a brand new best-practice image. This work is still in production today.
- SME for VM and container platforms and on-call duties as mentioned.

Development Operations Engineer, 2017 (Jul) - 2018 (Dec), MYOB Technology

Owner of cloud accounts, build infra, and CI/CD

- GitHub release tooling. A command-line one-stop shop for distributing software on GitHub. Semantic version, changelog, release and artifact management.
- Staff and team directory service. A single source of truth for identity across in-house and cloud systems and services.
- Build infrastructure access controls. A simple set of ownership-oriented security controls for build infrastructure.
- Codified self-service CI/CD infrastructure. Fully connected, self-hosted, plug-and-play build pipelines and agents.

Achievements and Responsibilities

- SME for CI/CD, AWS server and serverless infra, Go and shell coding best practices.
- Advised a team of grads on project management and Go programming for their first major project. One of whom requested to join my team and was a mentee for the remainder of my time at MYOB.
- Public speaking: Go programming, DevOps, and serverless AWS. Presented to meetups, workshops, tech companies, and a university guest lecture.

IT Consultant, 2015 – 2017 (Apr), Melbourne University Student Union Ltd

Achievements and Responsibilities

- Created an organisational knowledgebase
- Repaired an operations database corrupted by a third party software upgrade
- Re-kitted a live broadcast internet radio station
- Provided full-stack web developer support for multiple websites
- First responder to network/web security issues
- Supported IT services and the projects division with ongoing projects

Noteworthy Repositories

- github.com/dedelala/disco, a labour of love that runs the lights at home. Featured in a lightning and subsequent full length talk at Gophercon AU 2023 and 2024.
- github.com/tr-d/jam, a data manipulator a la jq that supports yaml, toml, and go templates. Unchanged for years, rumour has it it's still in prod out there somewhere.
- github.com/dedelala/cv, this!

Talk to Me About

- Cats, sewing, interior design, bagels, color spaces, 1970s disco, classic house, Oaxaca, how to roll cables, valid flavours of pastizzi (there's only one, it's peas).

Education

- RMIT, 2014 – 2017, Computer Science (deferred)
- RMIT, 2008 – 2009, Music Industry (Technical Production)
- The University of Melbourne, 2005 – 2006, Electrical Engineering (deferred)